

Skin Genetics Consortium Authorship Policy

This policy covers four types of papers:

Key Consortium-wide papers: Key consortium results papers from the SGC (e.g. the main GWAS paper)

Secondary analysis papers: Secondary analytical papers that use results from a published (or in-progress) SGC paper

Papers requiring new analysis: Papers describing novel SGC results but that might only include a sub-set of the consortium (e.g. papers focused on a particular disease), or papers targeting a specific research question

Affiliated papers: Papers that in some way have affiliation with the SGC, but do not contain SGC results (e.g. the BJD perspectives article)

Over-arching authorship principles

The consortium follows ICMJE authorship criteria as its minimum standard and where possible will follow CRediT reporting of individuals contributions to a manuscript. Authorship should reflect contributions to the specific paper and consortium membership alone does not confer authorship on every paper. Limited joint first and last authorship is acceptable where this accurately reflects individual contributions. The authorship plan should be agreed in advance of substantial work taking place and agreed and updated as appropriate prior to submission. Where there is disagreement on authorship, the SGC co-ordinating team can review contributions and make a final recommendation.

Any manuscript or conference abstract that names either individuals or 'The Skin Genetics Consortium' should be circulate to the named authors with sufficient time to comment before submission (2 weeks for a conference abstract, 1 month for a manuscript).

Key Consortium-wide papers

These are considered key SGC output papers. Planning of these will be clearly articulated to all consortium members. Authorship of these papers are likely to be extensive and all individuals who have contributed according to ICMJE criteria [ICMJE | Recommendations | Defining the Role of Authors and Contributors](#) will be named as authors (likely several individuals per contributing cohort, plus other analytical and intellectual contributions). Any individuals who have contributed but who cannot fulfil ICMJE criteria at the time of publication may be moved to the acknowledgements section. Occasionally (e.g. for conference abstracts) a shorter list of authors may need

to be listed, which will include key contributors and “on behalf of The Skin Genetics Consortium”, where possible. The co-ordinating team hold a list of all SGC members and contributions, which will be used to form draft authorship lists for such publications. Cohort representatives will be invited to ensure that this authorship list is complete for their cohorts during manuscript preparation, only those directly involved should be named (e.g. automatic authorship solely due to being a cohort PI will unlikely meet ICMJE criteria). On publication of key GWAS meta-analyses, these meta-analysed summary statistics will be deposited as appropriate via the Skin Knowledge Portal and the GWAS Catalog.

These consortium-wide papers will acknowledge all specific SGC funding sources, as well as all relevant funding from individual cohorts and contributors:

SGC specific funding statement:

“The SGC is supported by the Leo Foundation (LF-OC-24-001718) and the National Institute of Arthritis and Musculoskeletal and Skin Diseases (K01AR075111, R01AR080796).”

Secondary analysis papers

Papers which utilise already published data should cite the original paper. We also encourage acknowledgement of the Skin Genetics Consortium.

Early access to unpublished SGC results may be requested by SGC members via the project proposal form. Resulting manuscripts should include ‘The Skin Genetics Consortium’ banner author and/or individual contributing SGC members, as appropriate. We encourage such projects to be undertaken within the context of an SGC working group, where possible.

Papers requiring new analysis

These will largely follow the same principles as key consortium papers, naming all individuals who have contributed, but may include only a subset of SGC members, according to the contributions to the work. We encourage mention of “The Skin Consortium” in the text to link the work to the consortium.

Consortium members are encouraged to propose these projects (via the project proposal form) and where appropriate, a working group may be formed. The SGC-member-PI will be responsible for maintaining a list of contributors to these projects for the purposes of forming draft authorship lists.

Affiliated papers

As these papers do not contain SGC results there is no prescriptive recommendation on authorship. For any papers where you wish to refer to the Skin Genetics Consortium (other than via citation), we ask that you seek approval from the SGC co-ordinating team via info@skingeneticsconsortium.org. It may be appropriate to identify a select group of SGC members to contribute and be named authors.

‘The Skin Genetics Consortium’ banner author usage. In general, we recommend fully naming all relevant authors on SGC manuscripts. However, in some cases it may be appropriate to use banner authorship. In such cases, at the point of manuscript preparation, the SGC co-ordinating team should be contacted to provide an appropriate list of SGC authors that should be represented under such a banner – the extent of this list, will be dependent on the project and be commensurate with contributions to the individual project. The manuscript should be circulated to and be approved by all authors under this banner.

SGC co-ordinating team is listed here: skingeneticsconsortium.org/our-network.html
And can be contacted here: info@skingeneticsconsortium.org